Electrical Safety Guide (sample document)

This is a sample document written for the Kioo demonstration. It gives general safety reminders and is not a substitute for the rules of your country or the training of a qualified electrician.

Before inspecting an electrical system

Before inspecting an electrical system, tell the people nearby what you are about to do and agree who is in charge of the work. Check that you are trained for the task and that you have the right protective equipment: insulated gloves, safety glasses and shoes with rubber soles.

Look at the whole area first. Check for water, damp floors, damaged cables, burn marks and loose fittings. Do not start if the floor is wet or if you cannot see clearly. Remove metal jewellery, because metal conducts electricity.

Find the main switch and the circuit breaker panel before you begin, and make sure everyone knows where they are. In an emergency the power must be cut quickly.

Isolating the supply

To isolate a circuit, switch off the breaker that supplies it and lock it in the off position with a personal padlock. Attach a tag that says who locked it and why. Only the person who placed the lock may remove it. This method is called lockout and tagout.

After isolation, never assume the circuit is dead. Use a tested voltage detector to prove that no voltage is present. Test the detector on a known live source before and after you use it, so you know it works.

Working near live parts

Keep one hand away from the equipment when you must touch a panel, because current that crosses the chest is more dangerous. Never work alone on live equipment. A second person must be present who knows how to cut the power and call for help.

Do not use damaged tools. Replace tools with cracked handles or worn insulation. Use only tools made for electrical work.

Cables and extension leads

Do not overload sockets. A multi-plug adapter that feels warm is a warning that the circuit carries too much load. Unplug it and spread the equipment over several sockets.

Replace cables with cracked or cut insulation. Never repair a cable with ordinary tape when it will carry mains power. Do not run extension leads under carpets or through doorways where they can be trodden on.

Emergencies

If a person is in contact with a live source, do not touch them directly. Switch off the power at the main switch if you can reach it safely. If you cannot, push the person away from the source using a dry wooden or plastic object, such as a broom handle.

Call the emergency services as soon as possible. If the person is not breathing, start first aid if you are trained. Treat every electric shock as serious, even if the person feels well, because heart rhythm problems can appear later.

Fire

Do not use water on an electrical fire. Switch off the power if it is safe to do so, then use a carbon dioxide or dry powder extinguisher. If the fire is spreading, leave the building and call the emergency services.